

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

A SELLER IS GOING TO TEXT YOU THIS WEEK ASKING IF THEY SHOULD KEEP THEIR HOME OFF ZILLOW.

Here's the honest answer, backed by the numbers.

D.J. Paris

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**A NEW LISTING
GETS ALMOST 180
VIEWS ON DAY
ONE. BY DAY FIVE,
THAT DROPS TO 60.**

That's Zillow's own Chief Industry Development Officer, testifying under oath, this week.

THE CLAIM CAME FROM SWORN TESTIMONY.

Errol Samuelson, Zillow's Chief Industry Development Officer, testified at the July 1-2, 2026 preliminary injunction hearing (Zillow v. MRED and Compass, Chicago federal court).

BRIGHT MLS AND DREXEL UNIVERSITY ANALYZED OVER A MILLION TRANSACTIONS.

On-MLS homes sold for about 17.5% more than comparable off-MLS homes.

\$54,000.

That's roughly what a typical seller gives up by going off-MLS, per the Bright MLS and Drexel findings.

OFF-MLS GETS PITCHED AS CONTROL AND PRIVACY.

What sellers don't hear is the price. Fewer buyers see the home. Fewer bids. A winning bid comes from a smaller pool.

**OFF-MLS IS A SERVICE TO
THE BROKERAGE. ON-MLS IS
A SERVICE TO THE SELLER.**

WHAT TO SAY WHEN THE TEXT COMES:

- 1** Don't give them your opinion. Give them the numbers.
- 2** 180 views on day one, 60 by day five. That's Zillow's own testimony.
- 3** On-MLS homes sell for about 17.5% more, roughly \$54K for a typical seller. That's Bright MLS and Drexel.
- 4** Then let them decide.

THE TAKEAWAY

NEXT LISTING APPOINTMENT, LEAD WITH THESE TWO NUMBERS BEFORE YOUR SELLER HAS TO ASK.

The seller who chooses off-MLS with the numbers in front of them made a choice. The seller who chose it because you didn't have the numbers got sold to.